

Fifteen minutes to a file that answers for you.

One workbook, five sheets you work in and one Lists sheet that feeds the dropdowns. Everything below takes less time than a coffee — and by the end the file tells you what you owe, what is unbilled, and how many hours you actually have free.

What this file does

It keeps every client project, every deliverable you promised, the invoice status you type in, and the hours you have available in each of the next 26 weeks — in one place, all cross-calculated.

Its one trick: when a new enquiry lands, the **Fit Check** tells you **YES**, **TIGHT** or **NO** with the number behind it, instead of you guessing.

It does not write, number or send invoices. It does not track time in the background. It sends no reminders, connects to no bank, invoicing tool or calendar, and calculates no VAT, sales tax or tax of any kind. It is not tax, legal or accounting advice.

The first 15 minutes

1. **Delete the 8 example rows.** Projects rows 5–7 and Deliverables rows 5–9. They ship filled in so the Dashboard and the colour warnings show something real the moment you open the file. Right-click the selected row numbers ▶ **Delete rows** (delete the whole rows, don't just press Delete on the selection — pressing Delete would clear the grey formula cells in those rows). Deleting whole rows keeps every formula in the file intact.
2. **Projects — type your live jobs.** Client, Project, Status, Fee agreed, Due. The project name in column C is the key of the whole file: the Deliverables dropdown and every per-project total are built from it. Keep names unique, and avoid * and ? inside them — those act as wildcards in spreadsheet lookups.
3. **Deliverables — one row per thing you owe.** Pick the project from the dropdown, set the due date and the planned hours. That is what turns into your weekly load.
4. **Week Capacity — your real hours.** Overwrite the 25 h per week with the hours you actually have for client work, and put holidays into *Blocked / time off*.
5. **Dashboard — read, never type.** Excel locks it read-only. Google Sheets drops that lock on import, so just don't type on it there.

Set once, then forget

Projects **B3** — your payment term in days (ships at 30). Projects **E3** — your target hourly rate, optional. Those two numbers drive the colour warnings and nothing else. They are yellow; so are the two Fit Check cells on Week Capacity. Four yellow cells in the whole file.

Excel, Google Sheets, LibreOffice.

The workbook is a plain .xlsx with plain formulas. No macros, no add-ons, no account, no internet connection. It works offline.

Microsoft Excel (recommended)

- 1. Unzip nothing — just double-click `Client-Capacity-Tracker.xlsx` .
- 2. If Excel shows a yellow "Protected View" bar, click **Enable Editing**. That appears because the file came from a download, nothing else.
- 3. Read the **Start Here** tab (60 seconds), then add your first project in **Projects**.

Google Sheets

- 1. Go to `sheets.google.com` and open a blank spreadsheet.
- 2. Menu **File** → **Import** → **Upload**, choose `Client-Capacity-Tracker.xlsx` .
- 3. Pick **"Create new spreadsheet"** (or "Replace spreadsheet") and confirm.
- 4. Formulas, dropdowns and colour rules come across. Three things do not: the print setup, the read-only lock on the Dashboard, and a few font details. Set print options once under **File** → **Print**.

LibreOffice & Apple Numbers

LibreOffice Calc opens the file out of the box. Apple Numbers works too — minor visual differences are possible. For the smoothest experience we recommend Excel or Google Sheets.

If a calculated cell looks empty on first open

Excel: press `Ctrl+Alt+F9` . LibreOffice: **Data** → **Calculate** → **Recalculate Hard**. Google Sheets recalculates by itself on import. Nothing is broken — the file simply has not run its formulas yet.

Which cells are yours

Cell colour	What it means
☐ White	You type here. Client, project, dates, amounts, planned hours, notes.
☐ Yellow	Set once. Projects B3 (payment term) and E3 (target rate); Week Capacity B5 and B6 (the Fit Check).
☐ Grey	Calculated — never type here. Days left, hours left, still to invoice, awaiting payment, days since invoice, free hours, load, every Dashboard tile. If you type over a grey cell you delete the formula for that row.

Amounts are currency-neutral on purpose — no symbol, no tax. Want € or \$? Select columns I:J and L:N on Projects (skip K, that one is a date) → Format → Currency. Nothing breaks.

The Fit Check — two cells in, one sentence out.

Top of the **Week Capacity** sheet. A new enquiry lands; you want to answer today without opening five files.

How to use it

Type the hours the job needs into **B5** and the date the client wants into **B6**. The file finds that week's Monday, looks up how many hours are free in that week, how many are free before it, and how much of the work already in that week you marked *Can move* on the Deliverables sheet. Then it answers in one sentence.

Verdict	What it means
YES	It fits in that week, with the spare hours named.
TIGHT	It only fits if you move a named number of movable hours out of that week.
NO	Either "not that week alone, but X hours are free between now and then — start earlier or split the job", or "X hours short even if you start today".

It answers only from the hours **you** entered. It does not estimate how long work takes and it does not know your speed. Garbage in, confident garbage out — so keep planned hours honest.

Reading the colours

Days left (Projects H, Deliverables J): green above 10 days, amber 4–10, red 0–3, dark red once negative. The countdown goes quiet by itself as soon as the row is Delivered, Approved, Closed or Cancelled — red always means "act now", never history.

Free hours (Week Capacity F): amber at 2 h or less, red below zero. **Load** (column G): amber from 85 %, red from 100 % — the point where you have promised more hours than you have.

Days since invoice (Projects O): amber in the last week before the payment term you set in B3, red once it is past. That is your own term, not a legal deadline — the file makes no statement about late payment law anywhere.

Invoice status (Deliverables L): turns amber when a row is Delivered or Approved but still "Not yet" invoiced. That amber is money you have not billed.

Three habits that make it work

- ① Every promise becomes a Deliverables row the moment you make it — with a due date and planned hours, even a rough guess.
- ② When something ships, switch the status and set the invoice status; the countdown and the load fall away by themselves.
- ③ Five minutes on the Dashboard every Monday: anything red is this week's job, and "Delivered, not invoiced" is this week's invoice.

Limits, licence and where to reach us.

What this file does not do

It tracks status only. It does **not** write, number or send invoices. It does **not** track time in the background. It sends no reminders. It connects to no bank, no invoicing tool and no calendar. It calculates **no** VAT, sales tax or tax of any kind, and it is **not** tax, legal or accounting advice. If you need any of that, this file sits next to your accounting tool, not instead of it.

Capacity of the workbook

60 project rows · 300 deliverable rows · 26 rolling weeks · 6 dropdown lists. Every row is already formulated to the last line — you never have to drag a formula down or copy one across. If you need a row more than the file holds, it is cleaner to start a second copy for a second business than to stretch the ranges.

Two small things that save an afternoon

- The **Linked?** column on Deliverables shows ✓ when the project name matches Projects exactly, and **not in Projects** when it does not. If a per-project total ever reads zero, look there first — a stray space or a renamed project is almost always the cause.
- Week Capacity **B13** ("Table starts") is a formula that rolls with today. Type any date over it and the 26-week window freezes at that week's Monday. Delete what you typed and re-enter `=TODAY()-WEEKDAY(TODAY(),3)` to make it roll again.

Licence

Personal use by one buyer, on all your own devices, for as many of your own client projects as you like. Please do not resell, redistribute, share the file publicly or include it in another product. Thank you — small shops live on that.

Support

Questions, or a formula that misbehaves? Message us on Etsy — we answer within 48 hours (1–2 business days). Tell us which sheet, which cell and what you expected to see; that usually gets you a fix in the first reply.